

# First Week After Pentecost

In Festo Smae Trinitatis

1962 TLM: Trinity Sunday and the one divine Name

**Source note.** In the 1962 Missale Romanum the Sunday after Pentecost is the feast of the Most Holy Trinity. The distinct Mass of the First Sunday after Pentecost, beginning *Domine, in tua misericordia speravi*, is appointed for available ferial days of the week; it is treated below only as a separate comparison, not as part of the feast's proper sequence.

| Proper        | TLM text / reference                                               | Scriptural axis             | Connection                                                                                      |
|---------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Introit       | <i>Benedicta sit sancta Trinitas</i> (Tob. 12:6; Ps. 8:2)          | Blessing for mercy          | Before explaining the mystery, the Church blesses the Trinity and remembers mercy received.     |
| Collect       | True faith: acknowledge Trinity, adore unity                       | Confession and protection   | Firmness in the confessed faith guards the worshipper from adversity.                           |
| Epistle       | Rom. 11:33-36                                                      | Unsearchable wisdom         | Paul's inquiry ends in wonder and praise: all things are from, through, and unto God.           |
| Gradual       | <i>Benedictus es, Domine, qui intueris abyssos</i> (Dan. 3:55-56)  | Abyss and throne            | God sees the depths and reigns above the Cherubim; human unsearching yields to revealed praise. |
| Alleluia      | <i>Benedictus es, Domine Deus patrum nostrorum</i> (Dan. 3:52)     | Inherited praise            | The God of the fathers is blessed for ever as the Church ascends to the Gospel.                 |
| Gospel        | Matt. 28:18-20                                                     | One Name, baptism, teaching | Christ joins universal mission to baptism, commanded obedience, and his presence until the end. |
| Offertory     | <i>Benedictus sit Deus Pater... Filius... Spiritus</i> (Tob. 12:6) | Blessing returned           | The mercy proclaimed at the entrance becomes the praise carried to the altar.                   |
| Communion     | <i>Benedicimus Deum caeli</i> (Tob. 12:6)                          | Public thanksgiving         | Reception issues in confession before all the living.                                           |
| Postcommunion | <i>Proficiat nobis ad salutem corporis et animae</i>               | Sacrament and confession    | Sacramental reception and Trinitarian confession are asked to profit body and soul.             |

## Four Senses of Scripture

| Thread             | Synthesis                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
|--------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Literal</b>     | Romans 11 confesses judgments that cannot be searched out; Matthew 28 records Christ's authority, command to baptize and teach, and promise to remain with the apostles until the consummation of the age. |
| <b>Allegorical</b> | The one baptismal Name reveals the Father, Son, and Holy Ghost and gathers the nations into the teaching and sacramental life of the Church.                                                               |
| <b>Moral</b>       | The baptized are not merely to repeat the formula but to observe all that Christ commanded; the Secret extends that obedience into the offering of the self.                                               |
| <b>Anagogical</b>  | Christ's presence reaches to the consummation of the age, while the Secret asks that the worshippers become an eternal gift and Paul's doxology directs all things to God's glory.                         |

## Core Scriptural Symbols

| Thread                           | Synthesis                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
|----------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Name</b>                      | The Gospel gives one baptismal Name for Father, Son, and Holy Ghost; the Secret invokes that holy Name over the oblation. In Scripture the Name signifies divine self-disclosure and covenantal belonging. Here identity and worship are received before mission is undertaken. |
| <b>Abyss and throne</b>          | Paul's <i>O altitudo</i> is answered by the Gradual's God who beholds the abysses and sits above the Cherubim (Dan. 3:55). The images place reason beneath divine providence: the depth is real, but it is seen and governed from the throne.                                   |
| <b>Mercy</b>                     | Tobit 12:6 frames Introit, Offertory, and Communion. Mercy is first remembered, then offered back as blessing, then confessed publicly after reception. The repeated text gives the feast a history of gift rather than an abstract diagram of divine life.                     |
| <b>Offering</b>                  | The Secret asks the holy Name to sanctify the sacrificial victim and, through it, to perfect the worshippers themselves as an eternal gift. The altar therefore tests confession: the Name spoken over the baptized also claims the life offered with Christ.                   |
| <b>Presence and consummation</b> | The risen Christ sends the apostles and promises, <i>ego vobiscum sum</i> , until the end of the age. Mission is sustained by presence, and the end of mission is not institutional success but communion with the God whose glory the Mass blesses.                            |

## Patristic Exegesis of the Grouped Propers

The table offers an editorial account of the feast's complete liturgical sequence. Named patristic readings control particular texts where indicated; the Mass-wide synthesis is the work of this study sheet rather than a claim of patristic consensus.

| Thread                                 | Synthesis                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
|----------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Introit: Tob. 12:6;<br/>Ps. 8:2</b> | The entrance antiphon blesses Trinity and unity because God has shown mercy; Psalm 8 widens that confession across the earth. Editorially, gratitude is the worshipper's first condition: theology begins as received mercy and praise. |

| Thread                        | Synthesis                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
|-------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Collect</b>                | The Church asks to acknowledge the glory of the eternal Trinity, adore the unity in the power of majesty, and be guarded by firmness of faith. The prayer diagnoses both vagueness and presumption: revealed doctrine must become stable worship.                                                                        |
| <b>Epistle: Rom. 11:33-36</b> | Chrysostom, Homily 19 on Romans, is paraphrased: Paul knows that there is a depth but not its measure, and therefore speaks as one wondering rather than mastering the whole. The Epistle bends inquiry into doxology before the Gospel names the mystery.                                                               |
| <b>Gradual: Dan. 3:55-56</b>  | God beholds the abysses, sits upon the Cherubim, and is blessed in the firmament. Editorially, the chant answers human unsearching with divine sight and sovereignty, preparing the assembly to receive revelation rather than invent it.                                                                                |
| <b>Alleluia: Dan. 3:52</b>    | The God of the fathers is blessed and praiseworthy for ever. The inherited praise places Christian confession within salvation history and turns the ascent to the Gospel into worship.                                                                                                                                  |
| <b>Gospel: Matt. 28:18-20</b> | Hilary, <i>De Trinitate</i> II.1, treats this command as a comprehensive rule of saving faith; Basil, <i>De Spiritu Sancto</i> 10.24, is paraphrased: the baptismal command forbids separating the Spirit from the Father and Son. The Gospel joins the one Name to teaching, obedience, mission, and enduring presence. |
| <b>Offertory: Tob. 12:6</b>   | Father, only-begotten Son, and Holy Ghost are blessed because God has shown mercy. The offering does not leave doctrine behind; it returns the entrance confession to God as sacrificial thanksgiving.                                                                                                                   |
| <b>Secret</b>                 | The invoked holy Name sanctifies the victim, and through the oblation the worshippers ask to be perfected as an eternal gift. This is the ascetical hinge: those who confess the Name consent to be taken into Christ's offering.                                                                                        |
| <b>Communion: Tob. 12:6</b>   | The communicant blesses the God of heaven and confesses him before all the living. What was received in baptism and offered at the altar becomes public thanksgiving rather than private possession.                                                                                                                     |
| <b>Postcommunion</b>          | The Church asks that reception of the sacrament and confession of the eternal Trinity and undivided unity advance the salvation of body and soul. The sequence ends in participated healing, not in a solved concept.                                                                                                    |

**Grouped instruction.** The appointed feast texts move the faithful from mercy received to mystery adored, from the revealed Name to obedient mission, and from verbal confession to a self offered and sacramentally healed. The Trinity exceeds comprehension without remaining remote: Father, Son, and Holy Ghost name the life into which the Church baptizes, offers, receives, and is sent.

## Exegetical Notes

- Romans 11 is a doxology to God in its immediate grammar; its placement on this feast permits a Trinitarian liturgical appropriation without turning *ex ipso*, *per ipsum*, *in ipso* into three grammatical names for the Persons.
- Matthew 28 repeats teaching: make disciples, then teach them to observe. Mission includes formation in obedience, not baptismal administration alone.
- The Gradual's abyss and the Epistle's depth form an exact chant-to-reading echo; the Secret likewise joins the Gospel's Name to the sanctification of both oblation and offerers.

## Ferial First Sunday: Separate Comparison

The ferial formulary is not part of the preceding grouped-propers argument. Its Epistle (1 John 4:8-21) and Gospel (Luke 6:36-42) offer an adjacent post-Pentecost comparison: divine love becomes fraternal love, and the Father's mercy becomes the measure of the disciple's judgment. This comparison may supply a weekday application, but it should not be presented as though these passages were proclaimed in the Trinity Sunday Mass.

## Patristic and Sainly Witnesses

| Witness                | Text / source status                                                                                                                                                       | Interpretive contribution                                                                                                        |
|------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| St. Augustine          | Direct quotation, <i>De Trinitate</i> VIII.8.12: "Nay, but you see the Trinity if you see love."                                                                           | Charity does not replace confession; it disposes the hearer to perceive what Trinitarian doctrine says about communion and gift. |
| St. Hilary of Poitiers | Direct quotation, <i>De Trinitate</i> II.1: "What element in the mystery of man's salvation is not included in those words? What is forgotten, what left in darkness?"     | Keep the homily centered on Christ's whole command: Name, baptism, teaching, obedience, presence, and final horizon.             |
| St. John Chrysostom    | Paraphrase, Homily 19 on Romans 11:33: Paul knows the reality of the depth but not its measure, so his words are wonder rather than mastery.                               | Give intellectual humility a positive form: awe is the fitting completion of real inquiry.                                       |
| St. Basil the Great    | Paraphrase, <i>De Spiritu Sancto</i> 10.24: Christ's baptismal command ranks the Spirit with Father and Son and cannot be reconciled with treating the Spirit as inferior. | Show why the baptismal formula governs both orthodox confession and equal worship.                                               |

## Homiletic Synthesis

| Thread                                       | Synthesis                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|----------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Proposition</b>                           | The one divine Name is not a puzzle to master but the saving life received in baptism, adored at the altar, and obeyed in mission.                                                                |
| <b>Movement I — gift</b>                     | God first shows mercy, reveals Father, Son, and Holy Ghost, and gives Christ's presence to the teaching Church until the end of the age.                                                          |
| <b>Movement II — resistance</b>              | Pride tries either to master the depth or to reduce doctrine to a formula that leaves conduct and self-possession untouched.                                                                      |
| <b>Movement III — sacramental conversion</b> | At the Offertory praise is returned; in the Secret the holy Name sanctifies the victim and draws the offerers into an eternal gift; Communion makes confession thanksgiving received in the body. |
| <b>Final horizon</b>                         | Observe all Christ commanded, carry the Name to the nations, and live toward the consummation in which faith's doxology becomes direct communion with God.                                        |

## Preaching Applications

- Correct false humility: incomprehensibility forbids mastery, not confession, worship, or careful teaching.
- Ask which command of Christ the baptized hearer acknowledges verbally but has not yet begun to observe.
- Invite the congregation to join one concrete duty or relationship to the Secret’s petition: make us, through this offering, an eternal gift to you.

## Primary References

- *Missale Romanum* 1962, Proprium de Tempore, *In Festo Ssmae Trinitatis*; local OCR corpus identified in the README. Psalm numbering follows the missal’s Vulgate numbering.
- St. Augustine, *De Trinitate* VIII.8.12, NPNF working translation: <https://www.newadvent.org/fathers/130108.htm>.
- St. Hilary of Poitiers, *De Trinitate* II.1, NPNF working translation: <https://www.newadvent.org/fathers/330202.htm>.
- St. John Chrysostom, Homily 19 on Romans, at Rom. 11:33, NPNF working translation: <https://www.newadvent.org/fathers/210219.htm>.
- St. Basil the Great, *De Spiritu Sancto* 10.24, NPNF working translation: <https://www.newadvent.org/fathers/3203.htm>.

## Full Patristic and Saintly Texts

- St. Augustine, *De Trinitate* VIII.8.12: “Nay, but you see the Trinity if you see love.”
- St. Hilary of Poitiers, *De Trinitate* II.1: “What element in the mystery of man’s salvation is not included in those words? What is forgotten, what left in darkness?”